

NOVEMBER ASSESSMENT: 2ND YEAR ENGLISH REVISION

Part 1: Short questions

1. I am a Jewish man and a moneylender. I hate Antonio because he is Christian and gives out loans without interest. Which character am I? Shylock
2. I am Shylock's daughter. I love my father, but I am embarrassed by his religion. Which character am I? Jessica
3. I am a wealthy merchant. My mind is always on the ocean. I am naive, but pride myself on being a good friend. Which character am I? Antonio
4. I am a servant, however not as faithful as I should be. I let the devil decide my actions. Which character am I? Mr. Launcelot
5. I live in Belmont. I am wealthy, good-looking and well-educated. I cannot make decisions for myself. Which character am I? Portia
6. Which caskets do each of Portia's suitors have to choose between?:
Lead, Silver and Gold
8. Who does Bassanio agree to bring with him to Belmont?:
Gratiano, Launcelot, Portia Gratiano
9. Which character begins the play by saying 'In sooth I know not why I am so sad':
Antonio, Bassanio, Salerio Antonio
10. What does Bassanio want money for?
To win Portia
11. Which character says 'ships are but boards, sailors but men':
Antonio, Bassanio, Shylock Antonio

Part 2: Quotations

Name the character who says the following quotes in 'The Merchant of Venice':

1. 'I hold the world but... as a stage where every man must play a part' Antonio
2. 'In Belmont is a lady richly left / And she is fair' Bassanio
3. 'The devil can cite scripture for his purpose' Bassanio
4. 'All that glisters is not gold' Gold casket
5. 'My daughter, O my ducats, O my daughter!' Shylock
6. 'If you prick us, do we not bleed?' Shylock
7. 'This bond doth give thee here no jot of blood' Portia
8. 'Alack, what heinous sin is it in me / To be ashamed to be my father's child?' Jessica

NOVEMBER ASSESSMENT: 2ND YEAR ENGLISH REVISION

9. 'I will buy with you, sell with you, talk with you, walk with you... but I will not eat with you, drink with you nor pray with you' Shylock
10. 'I may neither choose who I would nor refuse who I dislike' Portia

Part 3: Analyzing an extract from 'The Merchant of Venice'

Read the extract on the next page and answer the questions which follow.

Extract from ACT I SCENE iii Venice. A public place.

SHYLOCK	Three thousand ducats; 'tis a good round sum.	
	Three months from twelve; then, let me see; the rate-	
SOLANIO	Well, Shylock, shall we be beholding to you?	
SHYLOCK	Signior Antonio, many a time and oft	
	In the Rialto you have rated me	5
	About my monies and my usances:	
	Still have I borne it with a patient shrug,	
	For sufferance is the badge of all our tribe.	
	You call me misbeliever, cut-throat dog,	
	And spit upon my Jewish gaberdine,	10
	And all for use of that which is mine own.	
	Well then, it now appears you need my help:	
	Go to, then; you come to me, and you say	
	'Shylock, we would have monies:' you say so;	
	You, that did void your rheum upon my beard	15
	And foot me as you spurn a stranger cur	
	Over your threshold: monies is your suit.	
	What should I say to you? Should I not say	
	'Hath a dog money? Is it possible	
	A cur can lend three thousand ducats?' Or	20
	Shall I bend low and in a bondman's key,	
	With bated breath and whispering humbleness, Say this;	
	'Fair sir, you spit on me on Wednesday last;	
	You spurn'd me such a day; another time	
	You call'd me dog; and for these courtesies	25
	I'll lend you thus much monies'?	
ANTONIO	I am as like to call thee so again,	
	To spit on thee again, to spurn thee too.	
	If thou wilt lend this money, lend it not	
	As to thy friends; for when did friendship take	30
	A breed for barren metal of his friend?	
	But lend it rather to thine enemy,	
	Who, if he break, thou mayst with better face	
	Exact the penalty.	

NOVEMBER ASSESSMENT: 2ND YEAR ENGLISH REVISION

Tick the following correct answers to the questions on the extract:

1. The tone of Shylock's response to Salanio's question 'well, Shylock, shall we be beholding to you?'

Cheerful	☐
Melancholy	☐
Amused	☒

2. What does Shylock mean when he says 'is it possible a cur can lend three thousand ducats?'

Is it possible a jew can lend you this money?	☐
Is it possible a dog can lend you this money?	☒
Is it possible an idiot can lend you this money?	☐

3. Which sentence is the best explanation of the following lines of the extract: 'lend it not to a friend... but lend it rather to thine enemy, who, if he break, thou may'st with better face exact the penalty.'

Don't lend the money to a friend, but lend it to an enemy instead. If an enemy can't pay it back, you will not feel guilty making them pay it back.	☒
Don't lend the money to an enemy. If an enemy can't pay it back, you will never get the money back.	☐
Always lend money to a friend. If a friend can't pay it back, you will not mind letting them away with	☐

4. What are the rules of the bond between Antonio and Shylock according to this section?

Antonio ~~and~~ gets 3000 ducats and will face a penalty if he can't repay it

5. Describe one thing that Antonio has done to lead Shylock to dislike him?

Spit on his Jewish gaberdine

6. Why does Shylock mean when he says that 'sufferance is the badge of all our tribe?'

NOVEMBER ASSESSMENT: 2ND YEAR ENGLISH REVISION

Jews have always been discriminated against

7. What word best describes the tone in which Antonio responds to Shylock at the end of this scene.

Enthusiastic

Condescending

Patient

8. Do you agree with Antonio that 'there is much kindness in the Jew' from what we have read in the play so far? Give two reasons why/why not using PIE.

I don't agree with Antonio that 'there is much kindness in the Jew' because Shylock hates Christians as a whole. He states it when he says "I hate him for he is a Christian", bluntly saying that he hates Antonio because of his religion. However, this lack of kindness doesn't come without reason. Shylock knows he has been dehumanised, crying in angst "If you prick us do we not bleed" showing that people view him as sub-human, not bleeding from wounds like a person.

Part 4: Sample answer:

Stage Directions for the Courtroom Scene in The Merchant of Venice

Introduction

In this performance of the court scene, the staging aims to highlight the tension between justice and mercy. Each element—costume, props, lighting, set, and characters' actions—helps bring Shakespeare's famous trial to life.

Costume

Key characters should wear simple but symbolic costumes to reflect their roles. The Duke appears in a dark robe to show authority, while Antonio wears pale, worn clothing to suggest he is "the tainted wether of the flock." Shylock's long coat and skullcap mark his identity, and Portia's lawyer's robe helps disguise her when she claims, "I have a power to do you service."

Ready, so please your grace

NOVEMBER ASSESSMENT: 2ND YEAR ENGLISH REVISION

Props

Only key props are used to keep the scene focused. A legal book lies open on the judge's table, echoing Portia's line, "The quality of mercy is not strained," as she reads from it. Shylock's small knife and a set of scales are brought forward when he demands "the penalty and forfeit of my bond."

I shall have
Lighting

Bright, cool lighting creates a formal courtroom atmosphere. A spotlight falls on Antonio and Shylock during their confrontation to highlight the conflict in "I stand for judgment." Softer lighting is used when Portia appeals for mercy, creating a moment of calm.

Real lighting for climax. "The court awards it"
Set

The set is simple but effective, with a raised bench for the Duke and two standing areas for Antonio and Shylock, reflecting the seriousness of "This court of Venice must needs give sentence." A painted backdrop of Venetian arches suggests a grand setting without overwhelming the stage.

"Call the law to court"
Characters' Actions

Movements emphasise rising tension. Shylock steps forward eagerly when speaking of the bond, repeating "I will have my bond." Antonio stands still and resigned, while Portia moves confidently between the two men, lifting her hand at the pivotal moment when she reveals the loophole.

Shylock says "I will have my bond"
Conclusion

These stage directions work together to underscore the drama of the trial and the powerful themes of justice and mercy at the heart of this scene.